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Quick attach backplate

Abstract

An attachment fastening system designed to enable quick attachment of different objects or accessories to a base plate. The system can be modified for use in multiple applications such as a modular backpack to be used for carrying various objects and accessories. The system can also be used to secure other external objects directly to the base as well. The system comprises a base and an attachment mechanism. The attachment mechanism has a modular design that can be used to easily swap out various objects or accessories from the base without the need for additional fastening tools. The 10 attachment mechanism comprises a base receiver and an attachment adapter, wherein the base receiver attaches and interlocks with the attachment adapter. Once locked in place, the attachment adapter becomes operably coupled to the base receiver and the object or accessory is safely secured to the base.

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Background/Summary

FIELD OF THE INVENTION
(1) The present invention relates generally to mechanical interfaces and attachment mechanisms. More specifically, the present invention discloses a mechanical interface that allows the user to easily swap out different attachments.
BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION
(2) Nowadays, different equipment is designed to accommodate different attachments or accessories. For example, various backpacks are now designed to accommodate external objects so that the external objects can be carried on the backpack. Similarly, other mechanical interfaces have been made available that help external objects to be attached to an object or surface. For example, hook and loop fastener pads have been made available to help attach different objects to the selected surface. Similarly, mechanical interfaces have been made available that allow for a more secure attachment of the external objects to the desired surface or body. However, the existing mechanical interfaces can be difficult to use which prevents the user from quickly swapping attachments. Thus, there is a need for a better mechanical interface that allows for quick swapping of attachments.
(3) An objective of the present invention is to provide a quick attach interface that allows for different attachments to be safely secured to a common interface for ease of storage and transportation. The present invention includes an attachment mechanism that creates a strong mechanical connection between two specially designed parts. Another objective of the present invention is to provide a quick attach interface that includes a base that can be a back-worn frame/plate. The attachment mechanism can include a base receiver that is integrated onto the base. The base receiver can be locking or non-locking, depending on user preference. Further, the different attachments can be extremely variable and can include, but are not limited to, a soft-shell backpack, a sunshade, etc. Furthermore, the present invention can be implemented into different applications such as in off-road vehicles or marine applications. The present invention can also be implemented in residential and commercial applications that require secure and removable attachment of devices to a permanent base.
SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION
(4) The present invention is an attachment fastening system designed to enable quick attachment of different objects or accessories to a base plate. The present invention can be modified for use in multiple applications. For example, the present invention can be implemented as a modular backpack that allows for different objects and accessories to be carried together in the same manner as a traditional backpack. The attachment fastening system can also be used to secure other external

objects as well.
(5) To perform this functionality, the attachment fastening system comprises a base and an attachment mechanism. The base is an elongated support structure of any size or shape that can accommodate the attachment mechanism. The attachment mechanism has a modular design that can be used to easily swap out various objects or accessories from the base without the need for additional fastening tools. The attachment mechanism comprises a base receiver and an attachment adapter. The base receiver mounts to the backside of the base, while the other side of the base receiver attaches and interlocks with the attachment adapter. The attachment adapter is a device designed to retrofit any object or accessory in a way that enables said object or accessory to detachably connect to the base receiver.
(6) To engage the attachment mechanism, the user first aligns each of the connectors on the attachment adapter with the corresponding receiver openings on the base receiver. Once aligned, the user then inserts the connectors into the receiver openings, thereby joining the attachment adapter to the base receiver in an unlocked position. To lock the connectors in place, the user slides the connectors vertically along a slotted path integrated into the base receiver. Once locked in place, the attachment adapter is now operably coupled to the base receiver and the object or accessory is safely secured to the base.
(7) In the preferred embodiment, the present invention further comprises a spring-loaded lock integrated into the base receiver. When activated, the spring-loaded lock holds the attachment adapter to the base receiver in the locked position. When deactivated, the spring-loaded lock quickly releases the attachment adapter from the locked position, allowing the user to detach the attachment adapter from the base receiver.
(8) The spring-loaded lock utilizes a slide latch mounted within a cavity of the base receiver. When activated, the slide latch blocks the pathway of one of the connectors, which in turn, prevents the connector from aligning with the receiver opening. This misalignment keeps the connector in the locked position until the spring-loaded lock is disengaged.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS
(1) FIG. **1** is a top-rear perspective view of the present invention.
(2) FIG. **2** is a bottom-front perspective view of the present invention.
(3) FIG. **3** is a front elevational view of the present invention.
(4) FIG. **4** is a top perspective exploded view of the present invention.
(5) FIG. **5** is a bottom perspective exploded view of the present invention.
(6) FIG. **6** is a front elevational view of the attachment mechanism of the present invention, shown in an unlocked position.
(7) FIG. **7** is an enlarged, cross-sectional view taken along lines **7-7** in FIG. **6**, showing the connector disengaged from the base receiver.
(8) FIG. **8** is a front elevational view of the attachment mechanism of the present invention, shown in a locked position.
(9) FIG. **9** is an enlarged, cross-sectional view taken along lines **9-9** in FIG. **8**, showing the connector engaged with the base receiver.
(10) FIG. **10** is a front elevational view of an alternative embodiment of the base of the present invention.
(11) FIG. **11** is a top-front perspective view of an alternative embodiment of the present invention.
DETAIL DESCRIPTIONS OF THE INVENTION
(12) All illustrations of the drawings are for the purpose of describing selected versions of the present invention and are not intended to limit the scope of the present invention.

(13) Hereinafter, the term “front face” refers to the forward-most surface of any given component of the present invention (i.e., nearest the user/structure carrying the base). Conversely, the term “rear face” refers to the aft-most surface of any given component of the present invention (i.e., nearest the attachment).

(14) In reference to FIGS. **1-11**, the present invention is a quick attach interface, hereinafter referred to as an attachment fastening system **1**. The attachment fastening system **1** is designed to enable quick attachment of different objects or accessories to a base **2**. The present invention can be modified to be utilized in different applications. For example, the present invention can be implemented as a modular backpack that allows for different objects and accessories to be carried together in the same manner as a traditional backpack. The present invention can also be used to secure other external objects as well.

(15) As can be seen in FIGS. **1-3**, the attachment fastening system **1** comprises a base **2** and an attachment mechanism **3**. The base **2** is a support structure that accommodates the attachment mechanism **3** as well as any attachment secured to the base **2**. With this arrangement, the user can carry various types of attachments mounted to the base **2** via the attachment mechanism **3**. The attachment mechanism **3** has a modular design, allowing the user to easily swap different types of objects or accessories from a common supporting base **2**. The base **2** can be any flat, elongated structure with a shape and size that meets the requirements set by the desired application.

(16) In a preferred embodiment, as seen in FIG. **10**, the base **2** may further comprise a plurality of openings **23**. The plurality of openings **23** can be used to attach various objects to the base **2** via one or more fastening devices **24** (e.g., buckle strap, keychain, clasp hook), all of which function independently of the attachment mechanism **3**. In other words, the user can remove and detach the attachment mechanism **3** from the base **2** without having to remove any of the fastening devices **24** from the plurality of openings **23**. In one embodiment, as seen in FIG. **11**, the fastening device **24** is a plurality of straps **24′** arranged to form at least one closed loop. In this embodiment, the straps allow the user to carry the base **2** as a backpack, along with any other accessories attached to the base **2** via the attachment mechanism **3**.

(17) The attachment mechanism **3** is designed to enable the quick attachment and detachment of select accessories without the need for additional fastening tools. As best seen in FIG. **4** and FIG. **5**, the attachment mechanism **3** comprises a base receiver **4** and an attachment adapter **5**. The base **2** is connected to the base receiver **4**. More specifically, the front face **41** of the base receiver **4** is attached to the rear face **22** of the base **2** using any means of attachment known in the art, including but not limited to adhesive bonding, threaded fasteners, or quarter turn latches. The base receiver **4** is designed to hold and secure any attachment to the base **2** via the attachment adapter **5**. The attachment adapter **5** is designed to retrofit any object or accessory in a way that enables said object or accessory to detachably connect to the base receiver **4**. Specifically, the object or accessory connects to or integrates with the rear face **52** of the attachment adapter **5**, while the front face **51** of the attachment adapter **5** is configured to detachably connect with the base receiver **4**. This arrangement allows the user to swap any attachment with another attachment that is also equipped with an attachment adapter **5**. Alternatively, the user can remove the attachment adapter **5** from the unwanted attachment and equip the desired attachment with said attachment adapter **5**.

(18) In reference to FIGS. **6-9**, the base receiver **4** and the attachment adapter **5** are configured to connect and interlock with one another. To activate the attachment mechanism **3**, the user first aligns each of the connectors **53** of the attachment adapter **5** with each of the corresponding receiver openings **43** of the base receiver **4**. As seen in FIGS. **6-7**, the user then inserts the connectors **53** into the receiver openings **43**, thereby joining the attachment adapter **5** to the base receiver **4** in an unlocked position. As seen in FIGS. **8-9**, to lock the connectors **53** in place, the user then slides the connectors **53** vertically along a slotted path integrated into the base receiver **4**. Once locked in place, the attachment adapter **5** is now operably coupled to the base receiver **4** and the object or accessory is safely secured to the base **2**. To disengage and remove the attachment

from the base **2**, the user simply follows the same steps in reverse. Specifically, the user slides the connectors **53** into the unlocked position by aligning the connectors **53** with the receiver openings **43**. Once aligned, the user can then safely detach the attachment adapter **5** from the base receiver **4**, which effectively removes the object or accessory from the base **2**.

(19) The base receiver **4** is an elongated body comprising a front face **41**, a rear face **42**, at least one receiver opening **43**, and at least one recessed slot **44**. As seen in FIG. **6**, the at least one receiver opening **43** is disposed on the rear face **42**, traversing through the front face **41**. The shape and size of the at least one receiver opening **43** is defined by the shape and size of the at least one connector **53** on the attachment adapter **5**. Preferably, the receiver opening **43** is circular in shape. However, the shape of the receiver opening **43** is not limited and can take the form of any suitable shape based on design, user, and or manufacturing requirements.

(20) For proper engagement between the connector **53** and the base receiver **4**, the at least one recessed slot **44** is disposed on the front face **41** of the base receiver **4** and in communication with the at least one receiver opening **43**. As seen in FIG. **6**, the width of the recessed slot **44** is defined by the width of the receiver opening **43**. Moreover, each of the recessed slots **44** traverse longitudinally (i.e., vertically) from each of the corresponding receiver openings **43** to a predefined distance. In this arrangement, the at least one recessed slot **44** forms a slotted pathway for the corresponding connector **53**, allowing restricted path of travel of the connector **53** along the vertical direction only. This arrangement allows the connector **53** to slide into and out of the locked position, as illustrated in FIG. **7** and FIG. **9**.

(21) The attachment adapter **5** is an elongated body comprising a front face **51**, a rear face **52**, and at least one connector **53**. The at least one connector **53** is disposed on the front face **51**, extending outward. The position and shape of each of the at least one connector **53** is defined by the position and shape of each of the at least one receiver opening **43**. Thus, the at least one connector **53** is capable of being fully inserted into the at least one receiver opening **43**, thereby joining the base receiver **4** to the attachment adapter **5** in the unlocked position.

(22) To lock the attachment adapter **5** to the base receiver **4**, each of the at least one connector **53** further comprises a neck **54** and a flanged head **55**. As best seen in FIG. **7**, the neck **54** extends outward from the front face **51** of the attachment adapter **5**, and the flanged head **55** is terminally connected to a distal end of the neck **54**. Moreover, the flanged head **55** is larger diameter-wise than the neck **54**. In this arrangement, the backside of the flanged head **55** is configured to slidably engage with the recessed slot **44** of the base receiver **4**. The user can slide the connectors **53** vertically into a locked position, thereby securing the attachment adapter **5** to the base receiver **4**. The connectors **53** are effectively locked in place due to the misalignment between the connector **53** and the receiver opening **43**.

(23) In the preferred embodiment, the attachment mechanism **3** further comprises a spring-loaded lock **6** designed to secure and hold the attachment to the base **2** when activated. As seen in FIGS. **4-5**, the spring-loaded lock **6** is integrated into the base receiver **4**. When activated, the spring-loaded lock **6** holds the attachment adapter **5** to the base receiver **4** in the locked position. When deactivated, the spring-loaded lock **6** quickly releases the attachment adapter **5** from the locked position, allowing the user to detach the attachment adapter **5** from the base receiver **4**.

(24) The spring-loaded lock **6** comprises a slide latch **7** and a spring **8**. As best seen in FIG. **6**, the slide latch **7** is preferably a rectangular-shaped body, configured to slide horizontally within a latch cavity **45** integrated into the base receiver **4**. The latch cavity **45** is disposed on the front face **41** of the base receiver **4**, wherein the latch cavity is in communication with any one of the receiver openings **43** and a corresponding recessed slot **44**. Regarding position, the latch cavity **45** is positioned directly below the receiver opening **43** and oriented perpendicular to the recessed slot **44**. Regarding size, the latch cavity **45** is substantially longer than the slide latch **7**, allowing the slide latch **7** to move to and from the locked and unlocked positions. In this arrangement, the slide latch **7** slidably engages with latch cavity **45** and is operably connected to the connector **53**.

(25) The spring **8** is preferably a flexible body, comprising a flexible base **81** and a wedge-shaped protrusion **82**. The spring **8** is positioned within a spring cavity **46** integrated into the base receiver **4**. As best seen in FIG. **6**, the spring cavity **46** is disposed on the front face **41** of the base receiver **4** and in communication with the latch cavity **45**. Regarding position, the spring cavity **46** is positioned directly above and substantially centered with the latch cavity **45**. The flexible base **81** of the spring **8** is mounted within the spring cavity **46**, while a portion of the wedge-shaped protrusion **82** extends into the latch cavity **45**. In this arrangement, the wedge-shaped protrusion **82** is operably connected to the top side **71** of the slide latch **7**. Stated another way, the wedge-shaped protrusion **82** retracts inward into the spring cavity **46** as the slide latch **7** travels over and across the wedge-shaped protrusion **82**. The spring **8** applies resistive pressure to the slide latch **7**, requiring the user to forcibly move the slide latch **7** to and from the locked and unlocked positions. Thus, the spring **8** prevents the slide latch **7** from inadvertently moving into the locked or unlocked position when no force is applied.

(26) To access the spring-loaded lock **6**, the slide latch **7** is laterally integrated onto the front face **21** of the base **2**. More specifically, as seen in FIG. **3**, a latch opening **9** is disposed on the front face **21** of the base **2**. The latch opening **9** is aligned with the latch cavity **45** of the base receiver **4**, wherein a portion of the slide latch **7** protrudes outward and through the latch opening **9**. This arrangement allows the user to selectively engage the spring-loaded lock **6** through the base **2**.

(27) To operate the spring-loaded lock **6**, the slide latch **7** is first positioned away from the receiver opening **43**, allowing for proper clearance to insert/remove the connector **53** to and from the receiver opening **43**. To securely hold the connector **53** in the locked position, the slide latch **7** is moved across and into the receiver opening **43**. Once fully traversed, the bottom side **72** of the slide latch **7** makes contact with the top of the connector **53**, as seen in FIG. **9**, thereby obstructing the pathway and keeping the connector **53** misaligned with the receiver opening **43**. The misalignment between the connector **53** and receiver opening **43** keeps the connector **53** in the locked position until the spring-loaded lock **6** is disengaged.

Claims

1. An attachment fastening system comprising: a base; an attachment mechanism; the base being connected to the attachment mechanism; the attachment mechanism comprising a base receiver, an attachment adapter, and a spring-loaded lock; the base receiver comprising at least one receiver opening and at least one recessed slot; the recessed slot being disposed on a front face of the base receiver; the recessed slot being in communication with the receiver opening; the attachment adapter comprising at least one connector; the connector comprising a neck and a flanged head; the receiver opening being adapted to receive the connector; the flanged head being slidably engaged with the recessed slot; the connector being configured to slide into a locked position; the attachment adapter being operably coupled to the base receiver in the locked position; the spring-loaded lock being integrated into the base receiver; the spring-loaded lock comprising a slide latch and a spring; the spring being operably connected to the slide latch; the slide latch being operably connected to the connector; the spring-loaded lock capable of securing the connector in the locked position; a latch cavity being disposed on the front face of the base receiver; a spring cavity being disposed on the front face of the base receiver; the spring cavity being in communication with the latch cavity; the latch cavity being in communication with the recessed slot; the latch cavity being oriented perpendicular to the recessed slot; the slide latch being slidably engaged within the latch cavity; and the spring being positioned within the spring cavity.
2. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 1 comprising: the spring comprising a flexible base and a wedge-shaped protrusion; the flexible base being mounted within the spring cavity; the wedge-shaped protrusion extending into the latch cavity; and the wedge-shaped protrusion being operably connected to the top side of the slide latch.

3. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 1 comprising: a latch opening being disposed on a front face of the base; the latch opening being aligned with the latch cavity; and the slide latch being laterally integrated onto the front face of the base.
4. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 1 comprising: a plurality of straps; the base comprising a plurality of openings; the plurality of straps being attached to the plurality of openings; the plurality of straps being arranged to form at least one closed loop; and the base capable of being worn as a backpack.
5. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 1, wherein the receiver opening is circular in shape.
6. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 5, wherein the recessed slot is oriented vertically.
7. An attachment fastening system comprising: a base; an attachment mechanism; the base being connected to the attachment mechanism; the attachment mechanism comprising a base receiver, an attachment adapter, and a spring-loaded lock; the base receiver comprising at least one receiver opening and at least one recessed slot; the recessed slot being disposed on a front face of the base receiver; the recessed slot being in communication with the receiver opening; the attachment adapter comprising at least one connector; the connector comprising a neck and a flanged head; the receiver opening being adapted to receive the connector; the receiver opening being circular in shape; the flanged head being slidably engaged with the recessed slot; the connector being configured to slide into a locked position; the attachment adapter being operably coupled to the base receiver in the locked position; the spring-loaded lock being integrated into the base receiver; the spring-loaded lock comprising a slide latch and a spring; the spring being operably connected to the slide latch; the slide latch being operably connected to the connector; the spring-loaded lock capable of securing the connector in the locked position; a latch cavity being disposed on the front face of the base receiver; a spring cavity being disposed on the front face of the base receiver; the spring cavity being in communication with the latch cavity; the latch cavity being in communication with the recessed slot; the latch cavity being oriented perpendicular to the recessed slot; the slide latch being slidably engaged within the latch cavity; and the spring being positioned within the spring cavity.
8. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 7 comprising: the spring comprising a flexible base and a wedge-shaped protrusion; the flexible base being mounted within the spring cavity; the wedge-shaped protrusion extending into the latch cavity; and the wedge-shaped protrusion being operably connected to the top side of the slide latch.
9. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 7 comprising: a latch opening being disposed on a front face of the base; the latch opening being aligned with the latch cavity; and the slide latch being laterally integrated onto the front face of the base.
10. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 7 comprising: a plurality of straps; the base comprising a plurality of openings; the plurality of straps being attached to the plurality of openings; the plurality of straps being arranged to form at least one closed loop; and the base capable of being worn as a backpack.
11. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 7, wherein the recessed slot is oriented vertically.
12. An attachment fastening system comprising: a base; an attachment mechanism; a plurality of straps; the base being connected to the attachment mechanism; the base comprising a plurality of openings; the plurality of straps being attached to the plurality of openings; the plurality of straps being arranged to form at least one closed loop; the base capable of being worn as a backpack; the attachment mechanism comprising a base receiver, an attachment adapter, and a spring-loaded lock; the base receiver comprising at least one receiver opening and at least one recessed slot; the recessed slot being disposed on a front face of the base receiver; the recessed slot being in communication with the receiver opening; the attachment adapter comprising at least one

connector; the connector comprising a neck and a flanged head; the receiver opening being adapted to receive the connector; the flanged head being slidably engaged with the recessed slot; the connector being configured to slide into a locked position; the attachment adapter being operably coupled to the base receiver in the locked position; the spring-loaded lock being integrated into the base receiver; the spring-loaded lock comprising a slide latch and a spring; the spring being operably connected to the slide latch; the slide latch being operably connected to the connector; the spring-loaded lock capable of securing the connector in the locked position; a latch cavity being disposed on the front face of the base receiver; a spring cavity being disposed on the front face of the base receiver; the spring cavity being in communication with the latch cavity; the latch cavity being in communication with the recessed slot; the latch cavity being oriented perpendicular to the recessed slot; the slide latch being slidably engaged within the latch cavity; and the spring being positioned within the spring cavity.

13. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 12 comprising: the spring comprising a flexible base and a wedge-shaped protrusion; the flexible base being mounted within the spring cavity; the wedge-shaped protrusion extending into the latch cavity; and the wedge-shaped protrusion being operably connected to the top side of the slide latch.

14. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 12 comprising: a latch opening being disposed on a front face of the base; the latch opening being aligned with the latch cavity; and the slide latch being laterally integrated onto the front face of the base.

15. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 12, wherein the receiver opening is circular in shape.

16. The attachment fastening system as claimed in claim 15, wherein the recessed slot is oriented vertically.
